The Word of God

Purpose: To show the Bible is trustworthy

Centred on: Claims ,Content & Consistency; God wants to commune with us

CLAIMS

2 Tim 3:16

1. All
2. Gob Breathed/from God**(Divine)**

2 Pet 1:19-21

1. Scripture brings light, thus clarity - V19
2. Written by people whom God used **(Human) – V21**

Question: Isn't that an amazing claim. An Extraordinary claim. Extraordinary claims require extraordinary evidence. Illustration… *(Two piles of books- one from God, one, not biggest pile not God's) Very few books make the claims of the Bible.*

*Let me show you two pieces of evidence that support this claim

CONTENT

(A) The Picture of God

1 John 4:8 – "God is Love" - paint the picture of God

John 3:16 – "So Loved" - maybe draw the bridge

Romans 8:38,39 or 1Cor 13:4-8 – How awesome God is

Can you imagine a better picture of God than the one of unselfish Love. If you could chose no God or one like this which one would you choose. This is not the kind of God that mankind has invented.

(B) Predictive Prophecies

Isaiah 46:9,10 – God knows and declares the Future! Historians tell us of the past, Journalist tell of the present, but only God can tell the future 100%

John 14:29 – Before it comes to pass so you can believe

*Let me share with you one of the bibles amazing predicting prophecies

Daniel 2 - (Read entire chapter through).

Daniel 2: 16-19…Daniel didn't know the dream, but he knew the one who knew the dream! So he approached the king and asked for time. Then he approached his friends and together they sought mercy from God concerning the secret!

Spiritual applications: This took great faith. Ask God and we receive. Daniel took no credit for himself. Kneel before God and you can stand before Kings.

Seven predictive elements of Daniel 2.



A metal man that's crushed by a stone

#1 Medo-Persia conquered Babylon. 539BC

#2 Greece conquered Medo-Persia. 331BC

#3 Rome conquered Greece. 168BC

#4 Rome would be divided. AD476

#5 Overtures would be made to unite Rome.

#6 These overtures would fail.

#7 God would set up his own kingdom.

If each of these things came to pass it seems logical that the next (#7) will also

Now I'd like to give you 4 areas of evidence that I personally find persuasive.

Consistency: Cultural, Internal, Translational, and Experiential.

Cultural:

The Bible is trans-culturally popular in a way no other book has ever been before, which strongly suggests its supernatural origin.

Books tend to be popular in the culture and context in which they are written.

Internal: 66, 35, 1600, 3, 1 (same message)

The Bible contains 66 books written by between 35 & 45 different authors over a period of approx 1600 years throughout 3 continents (Asia, Africa and Europe). Despite these amazing statistics we

find a remarkable consistency in scripture. The essential message of scripture is both unified and consistent; the bible contains no essential theological contradictions. (in contrast -E.g. Koran written over 30 yrs. by one man that didn't change his mind)

A Good book about this - "When Critics ask" by Norman Geisuer

The Bible's internal consistency strongly suggests it's divine origin

Translational: OT & NT.

The OT- In 1947 one of the greatest archaeological discoveries of all time took place when the **Dead Sea Scrolls** were discovered. These were parchments/scrolls that were placed in clay jars for storage and then hidden in small caves. These scrolls are dated to approx 250 – 100 years BC. Evaluation of these scrolls revealed portions of every single book of the Old Testament expect one. Two of the best known scrolls were of the prophet Isaiah, and when comparing these ancient manuscripts with our Modern Hebrew manuscripts we find a 97%+ identical correspondence.

The NT- There are some 5800 ancient Greek NT manuscripts in existence today. When comparing these to our modern manuscripts, we find a 97% - 98% match.

Literary adistation of Jesus is 100 to 1 compared to Aristotle,Caesar,Socrates,Plato etc.. being conservative. As soon as your one generation from the event you rely on history.

- Mat 24:15 Quotes Daniel the prophet (AD30)
- Dead sea scrolls can be archeologically dated to older than 150BC
- The Bible is a collection of authoritive books not an authoritive collection of books
- AD300 Council of Churches got together and agreed on what they were already using

The Bible's translational consistency strongly suggests its Divine origin.

Experiential:

The testimony of millions of people from all walks of life, proclaim the Bible to be the voice of God to their soul. I have found the Bible to be the voice of God to my soul.

The Bible's Experiencial consistency strongly suggests its Divine origin.

APPEAL - Would you desire to keep discovering and studying the Bible?